arvind kumar

software engineer

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summary

I solve real-world problems with software. Over the past 11 years, I've grown from specializing in frontend and platform engineering to managing multiple engineering teams, while staying close to the customer and driving business outcomes. I do my best work at the intersection of technical depth and people leadership.

experience

Clipboard Health - Engineering Manager — Remote | Oct 2024 - Present

- Clipboard Health <YC batch of W17> is a multi-vertical marketplace (originally healthcare) allowing professionals to book on-demand shifts and facilities to access on-demand talent.
- Established AI adoption guidelines and a PR-review-first culture, doubling the rate of customer value delivered without defects. Coached engineers to maximize AI leverage, intervening later in the loop by investing upfront in agent-based project planning and setup.
- Managed 17 engineers across 4 teams and multiple restructurings, currently leading 2 teams in parallel.
  - Directed a ground-up redesign of the worker app (hundreds of thousands of MAUs), making time-to-book 1.5x faster through improved shift discovery, while modernizing the codebase to retire accumulated tech debt and accelerate future feature delivery.
  - Streamlined attendance tracking and timekeeping across the flex marketplace, reducing support tickets by 30%, and cutting timekeeping profitability loss by 5x through retiring paper timesheets, integrating with customers' time-clocks and AI-assisted clock-ins.
  - Spun up a 2-engineer frontier team to run high-velocity experiments. Shipped 6 full-feature experiments in 2 months, with 3 graduating into the core product, establishing a repeatable model for fast, low-risk business validation.

Clipboard Health - Platform Engineer — Remote | Dec 2022 - Oct 2024

- As a platform engineer, led initiatives and built developer tooling to simplify and standardize engineering processes. These projects spanned feature flags, auth systems, static analysis, database indexing, integration testing, security engineering and continuous deployments. These efforts resulted in a 5x reduction in SEV-1 and SEV-2 incident time and 2x improvement in cycle time for the org.
- Executed large-scale refactors at speed: refactored 400+ feature flag invocations to a standardized library with consistent context attributes, and raised 125+ PRs to standardize index definitions across every database model. Both projects were completed in under 3 weeks with 2 engineers.
- Authored 6 Investment Memos, 5 Technical Design Documents and 3 Best Practice Documents as a platform engineer, among other guides and internal documentation. The engineering IC onboarding guide which I authored and maintained became the most widely referenced document across the engineering organization, relied upon by new hires and experienced engineers both, reflecting the team's remote, writing-first, async culture.

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Xkit - Founding Engineer — Remote | Apr 2022 - Dec 2022

- Xkit <YC batch of S18> helped B2B SaaS app developers to deliver deep integrations to customers' CRMs.
- As a founding engineer, I worked primarily on the frontend. I built the CRM Link library which when integrated, allows a web app's customers to map relationships across concepts between the web app and their CRMs. Developers can then use the CRM agnostic Xkit API to directly interact with data in their customers' CRMs.
- I also maintained and built features for our other frontend libraries and products including the Xkit developer portal.

Quintype - Lead Engineer — Bangalore, India | Oct 2020 - Oct 2021

- Led the engineering of Ahead, a customizable frontend on top of the Quintype CMS which grew by 5x in number of customers and 20x in pageviews generated under my leadership.
- Took charge of the effort to improve platform performance and pioneered a server side rendering strategy that is today known as progressive hydration. This resulted in a 2x improvement in pagespeed and core web vital scores across customers.
- Reduced reported bugs by 18x and consequently improved metrics on customer retention:
  - Called attention to stability issues and obtained buy-in from management to address it.
  - Balanced tech debt cleanup alongside building new features in a sprint.
  - Bridged gaps in the QA process by introducing designer acceptance sign-off and prioritized writing of automated end-to-end test scenarios.
- Mentored a team of 6 engineers with biweekly 1:1s to discuss interests, growth and learning paths, and delivered half-yearly performance reviews.

Independent Consultant — Remote | Sep 2015 - Oct 2020

Clients include over a dozen local and remote startups. Apart from owning and executing development of software, I have also catered to various verticals and some marketplaces that include hiring, education, scheduling, logistics, incident management and disaster recovery.

Consulting Highlights

Crio - DevOps Engineer — Feb 2020 - Oct 2020

- Saved over 10,000 USD per month in cloud expenses by optimizing AWS infrastructure.
- Built new infrastructure using Terraform spanning a dozen services and over a hundred concurrent servers.
- Created QKart, a React learning experience that is now sold as part of the product and has been utilized by over a thousand customers till date.

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Geektrust - Full-stack Engineer — Oct 2016 - Oct 2017

- Proposed, got buy-in and implemented a microservice to instantly display updates to users' job applications in real-time.
- Evaluated candidate code submissions and assigned scores based on metrics such as performance, readability, testability, etc.

Pickcel - Web Developer — Sep 2015 - Oct 2016

- Drove the frontend and backend development of a real-time healthcare appointment scheduling and management platform.
- Constructed an inventory management frontend for customers to book advertisement slots on public screens throughout India.

proficiency

Frontend:
- React/Typescript
- Next.js

Backend:
- Node.js/Typescript
- NestJS
- Serverless

DevOps / SRE:
- Terraform
- AWS

projects

- Doppler - A zero configuration remote monitoring tool.
- ISS Flyby Alert - A React Native application to receive alerts for International Space Station flybys at your location.
- arvind.io - Source code for my blog and personal website. The project uses a novel implementation for optimizing client-side performance for what is today known as progressive hydration.
- ClicksToX - A browser game where your lobby races to get from one Wikipedia page to another in the fewest clicks.
- Dish - A remote management Discord bot for easy shell access.
- Pong - A minimal and resource-light implementation of real-time multiplayer Pong in Golang and React

open source

Contributed to and maintained numerous open source tools and libraries, including popular projects such as Gatsby, Terraform and DNSCrypt.
Refer to my Github pull request history for more details.